THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Mid-Term / Half-Yearly Examination · Session 2026–27 · Set 03

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 03	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option. **(1)**

A part of Nature becomes a resource only if it is technologically accessible, economically feasible and ..... .

(A) politically popular (B) available in every country

(C) culturally acceptable (D) renewable within a year

(ii) The Kaveri river is shared by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and — **(1)**

(A) Andhra Pradesh (B) Puducherry (C) Goa (D) Telangana

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Battle of Haldighati
2. Re-establishment of the Mewar Kingdom
3. Battle of Talikota
4. Timur's invasion of Delhi

(A) 2, 4, 3, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 2, 3, 4, 1 (D) 2, 4, 1, 3

(iv) Which queen of the Garha kingdom died fighting a general sent by Akbar in 1564? **(1)**

(A) Rani Durgavati (B) Rani Abbakka

(C) Tarabai (D) Ahilyabai Holkar

(v) Which Mughal emperor re-imposed the jizya that Akbar had abolished? **(1)**

(A) Jahangir (B) Aurangzeb (C) Shah Jahan (D) Humayun

(vi) In which language was the inscription on Chhatrapati Shivaji's seal written, in a departure from the prevailing Persian seals? **(1)**

(A) Arabic (B) Urdu (C) Sanskrit (D) English

(vii) Shivaji conceded defeat and signed the Treaty of Purandar with the Mughal general — **(1)**

(A) Shaista Khan (B) Afzal Khan (C) Dara Shikoh (D) Jai Singh

(viii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): The British victory at the Battle of Plassey (1757) owed much to conspiracy.
Reason (R): Mir Jafar, commander of most of the Nawab's army, stood aside during the battle.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(ix) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option. **(1)**

The destruction of the Vedapurishwaran temple at Pondicherry in 1748 was ordered by the French Governor-General .....

(A) Clive (B) Lord Wellesley (C) Dupleix (D) Marthanda Varma

(x) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: The Great Famine of 1876–78 caused the death of up to 8 million Indians, mostly in the Deccan plateau.
Statement II: Grain continued to be exported from India during the years of this famine.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(xi) The Election Commission of India was established in — **(1)**

(A) 1950 (B) 1947 (C) 1951 (D) 1962

(xii) Which Chief Election Commissioner (1990) is associated with voter ID cards and strict watch on election spending? **(1)**

(A) Sukumar Sen (B) S.Y. Quraishi (C) N. Gopalaswami (D) T.N. Seshan

(xiii) On which of the following lists can ONLY the Union Government make laws? **(1)**

(A) State List (B) Union List (C) Concurrent List (D) Local List

(xiv) Which of these states has a bicameral (two-House) legislature? **(1)**

(A) Rajasthan (B) Maharashtra (C) Punjab (D) Kerala

(xv) SWAYAM, an Indian platform mentioned as an enabler of production and skills, offers — **(1)**

(A) crop insurance (B) bank loans
(C) weather forecasts (D) online courses (MOOCs)

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) What is meant by 'stewardship' of natural resources? **(2)**

OR

2.(B) 'Nature ignores political boundaries.' Explain with the example of the Kaveri river. **(2)**

3. List any two subjects of the State List. **(2)**

4. Give any two reasons why European powers colonised other regions. **(2)**

5.(A) Differentiate between the Governor and the Chief Minister of a state. **(2)**

OR

5.(B) What is Question Hour? Why is it important? **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of the resistance of Rani Durgavati against Akbar's army. **(3)**

OR

6.(B) Explain any three features of the rule of Muhammad bin Tughlaq. **(3)**

7.(A) Describe in three points how Shivaji escaped from Agra. **(3)**

OR

7.(B) Explain any three features of the trade networks of the Marathas. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the activities of the Portuguese in India. Mention any five points. **(5)**

OR

8.(B) Explain the effects of the famines during British rule. Mention any five points. **(5)**

9. Differentiate between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of five points. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Pema's family farm was in trouble. Yields were falling and the cost of chemical fertilisers and pesticides kept her family in debt. They switched to compost, pest repellents made from neem and garlic, and growing several crops across the year. After about five years the farm thrived, selling cardamom, ginger and traditional vegetables at premium prices. In 2016, the whole state of Sikkim became 100 per cent organic, and farmers' incomes grew by about 20 per cent on average.

Questions:

(10.1) In which year did Sikkim become a 100 per cent organic state? (1)

(10.2) Name one natural pest repellent used by Pema's family. (1)

(10.3) Explain any two benefits Sikkim gained by going organic. (2)

11. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Rana Kumbha, a 15th-century ruler of Mewar in present-day Rajasthan, resisted the later Sultanates. He built Kumbhalgarh Fort on a ridge of the Aravalli hills. Its massive wall, about 36 km long, is one of the longest continuous walls in the world. Hill forts like this were difficult for enemies to attack and sheltered armies in times of danger.

Questions:

(11.1) Which fort was built by Rana Kumbha in the Aravalli hills? (1)

(11.2) How long is the wall of this fort? (1)

(11.3) Explain how hill forts helped rulers to resist invasions. (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Rani Abbakka I ruled Ullal in present-day southern Karnataka. She formed alliances and thwarted Portuguese attempts to take her land. She was captured and died fighting in prison. Her successor, Rani Abbakka II, made fireballs out of coconut shells and set Portuguese ships on fire. Their stories are remembered through the folk art of Yakshagana.

Questions:

(12.1) Which territory did Rani Abbakka I rule? (1)

(12.2) What weapon did Rani Abbakka II create to attack Portuguese ships? (1)

(12.3) How does this example show that Indians resisted European powers from the very beginning? (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> India has a young population — about 65 per cent of Indians are below the age of 35. This offers a 'demographic dividend', but only if the young are healthy, educated and skilled. At present, adult literacy is about 85 per cent for males and 70 per cent for females, so there is still work to be done. Online platforms such as SWAYAM and the National Career Service help young people learn and find jobs.

Questions:

(13.1) What percentage of India's population is below the age of 35? (1)

(13.2) What is meant by 'demographic dividend' in this passage? (1)

(13.3) What must be done to convert India's young population into valuable human capital? Give two points. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5) **(5)**

(I) Surat
(II) Haldighati
(III) Talikota
(IV) Korba coal field
(V) Kolar gold field
(VI) Kozhikode (Calicut)

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Surat located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Haldighati located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Talikota located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Korba coal field located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kolar gold field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kozhikode located? 1

